

CANYU GAO

School of Public Affairs and Administration, Rutgers University – Newark
111 Washington Street, Newark, NJ 07102
Email: canyu.gao@rutgers.edu | Phone: 862-405-5164 | [Website](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in Public Administration** 2027 Spring (Expected)
Rutgers University-Newark, Newark, NJ, U.S.
School of Public Affairs and Administration
Dissertation: The Contingent Effects of Artificial Intelligence on Public Management:
Evidence Across Bureaucrats, Public Organizations, and Citizens
Committee: Kaifeng Yang (Chair), Norma Riccucci, Gregory Porumbescu, Sanjay Pandey
- M.P.A., Public Administration** 2022
Renmin University of China, Beijing, China.
School of Public Administration and Policy
- B.A. in Public Administration** 2020
South China University of Technology, Guangzhou, China.
School of Public Administration

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Management, Digital Governance, Accountability, Social Equity, Organizational Theory and Behavior, Citizen-Government Relations, State and Local Governance

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Gao, C., Caldarulo, M., & Porumbescu, G. A. (2026). Linking Broadband Availability to Perceived Digital Skills: The Moderating Role of Education. *State and Local Government Review*, 0(0). <https://doi.org/10.1177/0160323X261455619>
- Yang, K., Gao, C., & Liu, Y. (2025). Behavioral ethics: Does it have a role in helping develop a better understanding of administrative ethics? *The American Review of Public Administration*, 55(4), 283-298. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02750740241305413>

PUBLICATIONS IN R&R AND UNDER REVIEW

- Canyu Gao and Norma Riccucci. “AI in Policing and Perceived Legitimacy: Does Gender Representation Make a Difference?” (R&R at *Public Administration Review*)
- Canyu Gao and Kaifeng Yang, “Perceived Reorganization-Induced Organizational Identity Threat and Affective Commitment: The Moderating Role of Public Service Motivation among Chinese Firefighters” (R&R at *International Public Management Journal*)
- Canyu Gao, “AI-Informed Public Officials’ Misconduct and Citizens’ Racialized Blame Attribution” (Under Review at *American Review of Public Administration*)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Canyu Gao**, “The Performance Effect of Government AI Adoption Across Racial Contexts: Does Centralization Help?” (Draft complete. Target: *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*)
- Canyu Gao** and Ricardo Bello-Gomez, “How Does AI in Public Decision-making Shape Performance Evaluation and Responsibility Attribution” (Draft complete. Target: *Public Management Review*)
- Canyu Gao** and Kaifeng Yang, “The Contingent Relationship Between Artificial Intelligence Adoption and Public Employees’ Job Satisfaction: The Case of U.S. Federal Government” (Draft complete. Target: *Review of Public Personnel Administration*)
- Canyu Gao**, José Acevedo, and Ricardo Bello-Gomez, “Deservedness in Administrative Errors and Racialized Perceived Legitimacy: Evidence from A Survey Experiment” (Draft complete. Target: *International Public Management Journal*)
- Canyu Gao**, Yifan Guo, and Kaifeng Yang, “Making Responsible AI Plans: Accountability Mechanisms in Practice” (Draft nearing completion. Target: *Public Administration Review*)
- Diego Galego, **Canyu Gao**, and Chris Walker, “‘New’ Policy Instruments in the Digital Government Era? Insights from a Scoping Literature Review and OECD Countries Reports” (Draft nearing completion. Target: *Government Information Quarterly*)
- Canyu Gao**, “Can AI Increase Bureaucrats’ Discretion? The Contingent Roles of AI Types, Role Clarity, and Trust in Leaders” (*Manuscript in Preparation*)
- Canyu Gao**, “Government Digital Transformation and Public Employees’ Leadership Competency for Resilience” (*Manuscript in Preparation*)
- Canyu Gao**, “The De-Adoption of AI in Government: Evidence from Child Abuse and Neglect Investigations” (*Data Analysis*)
- Yingxin Zhang and **Canyu Gao**, “Who Draws Audiences? Formal Authority and Public Attention to Government Social Media Accounts” (*Data Analysis*)

RESEARCH REPORTS & PUBLIC WRITING

- Gao, C.** (2026). *Slowing Down Artificial Intelligence in Policing*. New Jersey State Policy Lab. <https://policylab.rutgers.edu/publication/slowing-down-artificial-intelligence-in-policing/>
- Porumbescu, G., **Gao, C.**, and Caldarulo, M. (2024). Linking Broadband Availability and Education to Digital Skills. New Jersey State Policy Lab. New Brunswick, NJ: Rutgers University. <https://policylab.rutgers.edu/publication/report-release-linking-broadband-availability-and-education-to-digital-skills/>
- Gao, C.** (2023). *Digital Technologies Might Not Necessarily Reduce Cognitive Bias and Inequality*. New Jersey State Policy Lab. <https://policylab.rutgers.edu/publication/digital-technologies-might-not-necessarily-reduce-cognitive-bias-and-inequality/>

GRANTS, AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Dissertation Fellowship (\$1,000), The China-America Association for Public Affairs	2026
Dissertation Fellowship (\$30,833), Rutgers University	2026
American Society for Public Administration (ASPA) Founders' Fellows	2026
Research Grant (\$3,750), New Jersey State Policy Lab	2025-2026
Research Grant (\$800), Rutgers School of Public Affairs and Administration	2026
Graduate Fellowship & Assistantship, Rutgers University-Newark	2023-2025
Graduate Student Travel Awards, Rutgers University – Newark	2024, 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

- Understanding Public Administration and the Public Sector (Online, Undergraduate)
[4.85/5], Rutgers University, Spring 2026
- Understanding Public Administration and the Public Sector (In-person, Undergraduate)
[4.14/5], Rutgers University, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

- Data Analysis (Online, Graduate Core) *Rutgers University, Spring 2025*
- Study of Public Organizations (In Person, Graduate) *Rutgers University, Spring 2025*
- Principles of Public Administration (Online, Graduate). *Rutgers University, Spring 2024*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Co-Investigator, “AI in Policing and Perceived Legitimacy: The Role of Human Resource Practices” <i>Funded by New Jersey State Policy Lab (\$3,750)</i>	2025-2026
Research Assistant, Senior Citizen Digital Literacy Program in Newark <i>Partnership with the City of Newark Department of Recreation</i>	2024-2025
Research Assistant, Rutgers Lab for Experimental and Behavioral PA	2024-2025
Research Assistant, New Jersey State Policy Lab	2023-2024
Research Assistant, National Social Science Fund of China (NSSFC) Major Project, “Research on the Indicator System for the Modernization of China’s Governance System and Governance Capacity”	2022-2023
Research Assistant, National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC) Project, “Determinants, Reform Pathways, and Governance Outcomes of Local Governance Systems and Governance Capacity”	2021-2022

CONFERENCE PRESENTATION

- “AI and Job Satisfaction—Temporal Dynamics, Heterogeneity Effect, and Boundary Conditions” 2026 *Public Management Research Conference* (2026 PMRC), Washington, D.C.
- “When Bureaucracies Err: Loss Aversion, Deservingness, and Citizen Perceptions” 2026 *Public Management Research Conference* (2026 PMRC), Washington, D.C.

- “AI in Policing and Perceived Legitimacy: Does Gender Representation Make a Difference?” 2026 *Midwest Political Science Association Conference* (2026 MPSA), Chicago, IL.
- “When Governments Choose AI: Implications for Responsibility and Performance Assessment” 2026 *Midwest Political Science Association Conference* (2026 MPSA), Chicago, IL.
- “Racialized Accountability Judgments in Policing: How Does AI Make a Difference?” 2026 *American Society for Public Administration Conference* (2026 ASPA), Los Angeles, CA.
- “Linking Broadband Availability to Perceived Digital Skills: The Moderating Role of Education” 2025 *Northeast Conference on Public Administration* (2025 NECoPA), Union, NJ.
- “Algorithmic Effectiveness and Transparency: Understanding Public Employees’ Responses to Automated Decision-Making in the Public Sector” 2025 *Public Management Research Conference* (2025 PMRC), Seoul, South Korea.
- “Making Responsible AI Plans: An Accountability Framework and the State of Practice” 2024 *American Society for Public Administration Conference* (2024 ASPA), Minneapolis, MN.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory
Journal of Public Policy
Social Policy & Administration

Graduate Student Advisory Board Member

The China-America Association for Public Affairs

Conference Volunteer

2025 Northeast Conference on Public Administration

Policy Brief Editorial Assistant

School of Public Affairs and Administration, Rutgers University–Newark

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Society for Public Administration (ASPA)
 Public Management Research Association (PMRA)
 Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)

SKILLS

Methods: panel data econometrics, regression discontinuity (RD), instrumental variables (IV), difference-in-differences (DiD), computational text analysis
 Statistical Packages: Stata, R, Python, SPSS
 Language: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

Last updated: September 2026